

AI Infrastructure: Industries, Investment Horizons, and Model Design

Investment assessment

The evidence supports a large, continuing infrastructure investment cycle. It does not support treating every semiconductor, electrical supplier, utility, or former bitcoin miner as the same investment. The strongest research opportunity is to identify where spending becomes contracted revenue, where bottlenecks support margins, and where those improvements are greater than the stock price already assumes.

This assessment uses public information available on September 10, 2026 and the existing 183-name tracker. Company projections are management guidance, not realized outcomes. Proposed research groups and horizons do not change trading eligibility, position limits, execution authority, or production scores. Current prices, consensus histories, and option chains were not refreshed for this report; the company groups below are research priorities rather than a valuation-ranked buy list.

Three findings change the research agenda. First, the existing model has incomplete business coverage before its thresholds are applied. Second, AI spending is producing measurable supplier revenue, but deployment and financing determine when cloud operators collect cash. Third, the economic timeline is often several quarters, while the stock may reprice immediately when that timeline becomes more credible.

The distinction matters for substantial upside. A small supplier can benefit disproportionately when its product becomes necessary for a new architecture. A developer can appreciate when an uncertain project becomes funded and executable. Neither mechanism requires buying an option that expires before the uncertainty can resolve. The relevant question is the size and timing of the change in expected shareholder cash flows.

NVIDIA reported quarterly Data Center revenue of \$89.0 billion, up 117% year over year. Broadcom reported AI semiconductor revenue of \$16.7 billion, up 221%. Those are substantial operating results, while their forward guidance remains conditional. They support researching the supply chain; they do not establish which shares are underpriced.^{6,7}

For substantial upside, estimate the business improvement required by a valuation rather than reward a low multiple in isolation. A simple illustration: if earnings rise 50% but the price/earnings multiple falls from 40 to 25, the implied price ratio is $1.5 \times 25/40 = 0.9375$, a 6.25% decline before dividends. This is arithmetic, not a forecast. The same principle applies to growth companies whose valuation depends on future margins, dilution, and funding.

The recommended priority is a two-track study: connectivity and physical infrastructure for identifiable product and order conversion; cloud and infrastructure developers for potentially larger changes in capacity, funding, and utilization. Semiconductor equipment provides a separate manufacturing-cycle lens. Existing generation and advanced nuclear development require different timelines and financial measures.

6. [NVIDIA](#) 7. [Broadcom](#)

Universe coverage and measurement quality

The tracker contains 183 distinct tickers. Reference metadata assigns 82 to Technology, 57 to Industrials, 14 to Utilities, and 30 across other sectors. These are provider labels, not audited measures of AI revenue exposure. An industrial contractor may be more directly exposed to a buildout than a software company classified as Technology.¹

The edge-research artifact scores 40 names, or 21.9% of the tracker. Its source code first sorts by readiness, long-term score, and earnings proximity, then applies a 40-row limit. The frozen snapshot reproduces exactly the selected set. Consequently, the 143 omitted names have not failed a complete edge evaluation in that run. The separate conviction report does retain all 183 names.¹

Only eight of the 40 edge rows receive a recognized category. The registry maps 30 of 183 research themes; a later conviction report maps 33. Their generation times differ, so these are separate observations rather than a reconciled three-row defect. ALAB, CRDO, ANET, GEV, IREN, CRWV, NBIS, and CIFR are unclassified in both saved research views. FIX and EME are examined by the edge model but still unclassified.¹

There are two distinct problems: selection coverage and taxonomy coverage. Applying the existing category rules to reference metadata for all 183 names maps only 47. Removing the row limit alone would therefore leave 136 unclassified under those rules. The existing vocabulary emphasizes software, semiconductors, and internet businesses; it does not adequately express construction, electrification, or project development.¹

Finding	Evidence in the frozen inputs	Implication
Partial edge evaluation	40/183 scored; selection reproduced	A quiet longer-term opportunity can be excluded upstream
Limited themes	Registry 30/183; edge 8/40	Unclassified is not evidence of no business exposure
Uneven metadata	128/183 cached; 55 absent; 48 cached records older than 14 days	Full tracker retention is not full fundamental coverage
Conflicting growth	FIX cached revenueGrowth = 0.01; issuer reports about 50% quarterly revenue growth	Period and definition must be reconciled before scoring

The FIX discrepancy is high priority: the cache was fetched September 2, yet the issuer's July 23 release reports \$3.27 billion versus \$2.17 billion of quarterly revenue. The provider field lacks a period identifier in the saved cache. It may be stale, differently defined, or incorrect; replacing it with an assumed equivalent would be premature. A fresh fetch timestamp does not certify fresh financial observations.^{1,15}

NVIDIA's edge metadata is approximately 128 days old and still carries a 73.2% revenue-growth field, while its August issuer release reports 106% total growth. NVIDIA was outside this run's 40 selected rows. That demonstrates cache neglect in this module, not that every downstream score consumed the old number.^{1,6}

These findings are reproducible data and coverage defects or limitations. They do not establish a profitable challenger, and they do not show that lowering any numerical threshold would improve returns.

1. Frozen local coverage audit. 6. [NVIDIA](#) 15. [Comfort Systems USA](#)

Demand, capital spending, and funding

Hyperscaler budgets should be decomposed into chips, networking, buildings, power infrastructure, leases, and non-AI investment. Dollar spending also reflects prices and accounting. Adding unlike capital expenditure definitions can create an impressive but misleading aggregate.

Microsoft reported \$41 billion of quarterly capital expenditure, with roughly two-thirds devoted to short-lived assets, primarily CPUs and GPUs. It revised calendar 2026 capex to approximately \$175 billion because more datacenter leases move from finance to operating classification after a useful-life change. Management said the underlying investment expectation was unchanged. A model should not read that accounting-driven reduction as an equivalent cut in physical demand.²

Meta guided to \$130-145 billion of 2026 capital expenditure including finance-lease principal, narrowing its prior \$125-145 billion range. Amazon reported AWS growth of 36.7%, but trailing twelve-month free cash flow was negative \$7.6 billion as property and equipment purchases increased. Both show why demand growth and financing capacity belong in separate fields.^{3,4}

Alphabet remains a necessary demand bellwether, but a current primary Q2 2026 capex figure was not verified for this report. No four-company capex total is presented. The next comparable dataset should carry calendar or fiscal period, cash versus leased assets, accounting changes, and any identifiable non-AI spending alongside each company's number.

Oracle's September 10 report provides a particularly useful bridge from bookings to delivery. Quarterly cloud infrastructure revenue was \$7.4 billion, up 121%; the company reported 850 MW of additional capacity and \$664 billion of remaining performance obligations. It also reported negative \$5 billion quarterly free cash flow and a completed \$20 billion common-stock ATM program. Capacity growth, contracted demand, and financing dilution coexist.⁵

The analytical chain is: customer economics support a commitment; financing and delivery make capacity available; utilization produces revenue; revenue after operating costs, maintenance, debt, and dilution determines common-share value. Each stage can succeed while a later stage disappoints. A long contract can improve funding and still offer poor returns if equipment cost or obsolescence was underestimated.

Three demand measures deserve priority. Track revisions to customers' investment plans on a comparable basis; track revenue or billable capacity actually activated; and track renewal pricing and utilization for existing hardware. Repeating a large backlog number each week adds little information if the commissioning schedule and cash economics are unchanged.

The principal falsifier is deterioration in conversion: customers defer usable capacity, contract terms weaken, funding becomes more expensive, or revenue growth fails to cover the capital required. These are observable developments, unlike a general claim that enthusiasm has become excessive. Company-specific disclosure gaps should remain unknowns, with dated follow-up requirements.

2. [Microsoft](#) 3. [Meta](#) 4. [Amazon](#) 5. [Oracle](#)

Compute, semiconductor equipment, and connectivity

Compute suppliers and equipment suppliers occupy different positions in the spending chain. NVDA, AMD, and AVGO require product, customer, architecture, and margin analysis. ASML, AMAT, LRCX, and KLAC require customer manufacturing plans, equipment delivery and acceptance, utilization, and geographic exposure. Semiconductor demand can expand while spending rotates among manufacturing steps or suppliers.

NVIDIA said Vera Rubin was ramping into full production and described networking systems supporting both pluggable and co-packaged optics. Its next-quarter revenue guidance was \$108 billion, plus or minus 2%, with no assumed China Data Center compute revenue. Broadcom guided AI semiconductor revenue to \$21.7 billion in its following quarter. These disclosures make architecture and customer mix more informative than an undifferentiated semiconductor label.^{6,7}

ASML reported EUR9.3 billion of Q2 sales and guided to EUR11-12 billion in Q3. The relevant manufacturing thesis should distinguish ordered equipment from shipped and accepted equipment, and leading-edge logic from other end markets. Export restrictions, customer concentration, and spending deferrals require issuer-specific review; this report does not assume a uniform policy outcome.¹¹

Connectivity deserves a dedicated research group. Scale-up connects processors within a tightly coupled system; scale-out connects systems into a larger cluster. The products, protocols, cable distances, serviceability requirements, and economics differ. A higher bandwidth number is useful only when attached to a qualified customer deployment and a profitable bill of materials.

Astera Labs reported Q2 revenue of \$392.4 million, up 27% sequentially and 104% year over year. Management expected Scorpio fabric switches to become its largest product family in Q3 and guided revenue to \$540-560 million. That identifies a testable product-mix milestone with a quarter attached, rather than an open-ended AI narrative.⁸

Credo reported \$479 million of revenue, up 9.6% sequentially and 114.7% year over year, and guided its next quarter to \$525-535 million. Its disclosed portfolio spans copper and optical interconnects. A copper-versus-optics binary would misrepresent that business; track product mix, customer programs, margins, and the revenue contribution of new offerings.⁹

Lumentum identified optical circuit switches, 1.6T modules, and emerging in-rack optical opportunities as growth drivers. It reported approximately \$1.01 billion of quarterly revenue and guided to \$1.225-1.275 billion next quarter. Its large reported net loss also included a one-time non-cash debt-extinguishment charge. A simple profit screen can confuse capital-structure accounting with operating deterioration unless the reconciliation is retained.¹⁰

The proposed 2026-2027 research horizon is product qualification through meaningful revenue conversion. Record announcement, sampling, qualification, production, and material revenue as different stages. The falsifiers are customer delays, lost sockets, pricing pressure, lower content per system, or a ramp that fails to improve gross profit. Customer-funded development or warrants also require per-share economics, not just revenue recognition.

6. [NVIDIA](#) 7. [Broadcom](#) 8. [Astera Labs](#) 9. [Credo](#) 10. [Lumentum](#) 11. [ASML](#)

Electrical equipment, cooling, and construction

This group is directly relevant to datacenter pricing expertise because it exposes the gap between a funded order and an executable build. Research should follow equipment scope, power density, delivery availability, commissioning, change orders, and contract terms. Revenue exposure is often hidden inside a broader segment, so company-level growth needs an end-market bridge.

Eaton's Q2 sales increased 21%, including 14% organic growth. Its Electrical Americas rolling twelve-month orders grew 41%, while electrical-sector backlog grew 43%. Electrical Global's reported growth also included a substantial acquisition contribution. Organic and acquired growth must remain separate; otherwise a portfolio transaction can look like an acceleration in datacenter demand.¹²

Vertiv reported \$3.274 billion of quarterly sales, up 24%, and an adjusted operating margin of 22.6%. It described temporary supply-chain congestion and phased project execution affecting timing, while raising full-year guidance. This is a useful counterexample to a model that interprets every near-term shipment delay as a broken demand thesis. It is equally a warning that an intact thesis may not deliver within a short option's life.¹³

Comfort Systems reported \$14.06 billion of backlog, versus \$12.45 billion the previous quarter and \$8.12 billion a year earlier. Same-store backlog was \$13.70 billion. This supports investigating backlog conversion and construction capacity, but the backlog should not be treated as current-quarter revenue or as wholly datacenter revenue. FIX's official operating evidence is materially richer than its current unclassified label.¹⁵

GE Vernova reported gas equipment backlog plus slot reservation agreements of 116 GW, with at least 125 GW expected by year-end 2026. The combined metric is not operating generation capacity and does not make every reserved slot a completed sale. Contracts, reservations, shipment timing, deposits, and service obligations should be separately represented.¹⁴

Research subgroup	Existing names to review	Measures that distinguish outcomes
Electrical distribution and components	ETN, NVT, HUBB, WCC, APH, BDC	Organic orders, pricing versus cost, capacity, lead-time changes
Cooling and thermal systems	VRT, MOD, TT, CARR, JCI	Datacenter mix, liquid-cooling qualification, service revenue, margins
Construction and grid execution	FIX, EME, PWR, STRL, MYRG, MTZ	Funded backlog, mobilization, labor productivity, cash conversion
Generation equipment	GEV, CAT, CMI	Firm order versus reservation, delivery slots, service economics

These groupings are research hypotheses for issuer verification, not equal-exposure assertions. For example, a broad HVAC company needs a different materiality threshold than a specialist cooling supplier. Copper prices can raise supplier revenue while compressing customer margins; FCX commodity exposure is a separate mechanism from selling a datacenter electrical system.

Use the next two to eight quarters to evaluate delivery conversion, with project-level dates where disclosed. Falling lead times can mean successful capacity expansion or weaker demand. Read them alongside new orders, cancellation rates, utilization, pricing, and margins. The strongest falsifier is rising backlog accompanied by persistent cost overruns, weaker cash conversion, and repeated schedule extensions.

12. [Eaton](#) 13. [Vertiv](#) 14. [GE Vernova](#) 15. [Comfort Systems USA](#)

Cloud operators and infrastructure developers

ORCL, CRWV, IREN, NBIS, CIFR, and APLD need company- and project-specific economics. Owning powered land, leasing a shell, selling GPU capacity, and operating a cloud software platform are different business models. A historical mining label does not describe an executed AI contract, and a proposed conversion does not establish a profitable cloud operation.

CoreWeave reported \$2.575 billion of Q2 revenue, approximately \$104 billion of revenue backlog, 1.5 GW of active power, and approximately 3.7 GW of contracted power. Its backlog definition includes amounts beyond remaining performance obligations and is conditional on delivery and service availability. Quarterly net interest expense was \$640 million and net loss \$626 million, despite 59% adjusted EBITDA margin. EBITDA alone misses material economics for a financed, depreciating asset base.¹⁶

IREN reported \$4 billion of contracted annualized run-rate revenue for 2026 capacity against \$1 billion operating at the time of its August update. Horizon 1 had been delivered to Microsoft; Horizon 2 was commissioning and Horizon 3-4 were targeting Q4 2026 delivery. Recent customer prepayments represented 45-55% of associated GPU capex. Contracted ARR, operating ARR, and recognized annual revenue must be separate measures.¹⁷

Nebius reported \$582.3 million of Q2 group revenue. Its August letter said many new deals relied on capacity arriving in late 2026, with the main revenue contribution in 2027. It raised its year-end contracted-power target to 5 GW and described substantial customer prepayments. Those disclosures establish a forward delivery test; they do not establish that 5 GW was already connected or billing.¹⁸

Cipher Digital's August presentation distinguished 700 MW of contracted gross HPC capacity from an approximately 4.4 GW grid pipeline expected across 2027-2030 and later, subject to the ERCOT batch process. The model must preserve gross electrical MW versus IT-load MW and pipeline versus contracted versus operating status. A headline summing them would overstate available capacity.¹⁹

The proposed project record should contain site, customer, binding contract status, gross and IT MW, funding closed and conditional, required capex, equipment ownership, energization, customer acceptance, billable start, and revenue recognition. It should also retain contract duration, renewal assumptions, prepayment obligations, cost of debt, security interests, and common-share dilution when disclosed.

Capacity economics should be evaluated with cohorts. Revenue per MW is not comparable across different hardware generations, power definitions, utilization, or service bundles. An auction price for a short contract should not be multiplied across a multi-year fleet. Similarly, customer prepayments improve cash timing but create delivery obligations; their receipt is not free cash available without an associated build cost.

The potential upside mechanism is conversion from uncertain capacity to funded, accepted, billable service with durable returns. The downside mechanism is funding arriving later or costing more, equipment aging before utilization, customer dependence, or obligations outlasting attractive pricing. These companies warrant close milestone research without assuming that the highest projected growth creates the highest expected stock return.

16. [CoreWeave](#) 17. [IREN](#) 18. [Nebius Group](#) 19. [Cipher Digital](#)

Power availability and other distinct investment cycles

Physical power constraints extend the investment horizon, but they affect different businesses differently. The IEA's 2026 update projects datacenter electricity use rising from 485 TWh in 2025 to about 950 TWh in 2030. It identifies tighter energy and chip bottlenecks and warns that onsite gas generation is not necessarily a fast substitute for grid connection. These are forecasts and system-level constraints, not company revenue commitments.²⁰

Existing generators such as CEG and VST should be evaluated through available output, outages, hedges, contract pricing, and counterparty terms. Regulated utilities such as DUK, SO, AEE, and D require a different analysis of approved investment, customer cost recovery, and financing. Utilities should not receive the same price-realization assumption as merchant generation.

Constellation's August update reported 920 MW of additional long-term power purchase agreements and progress toward a 2027 Crane restart. It also described unfavorable nuclear outages affecting results. Contracted sales, restarted capacity, and actual operating output are therefore separate milestones even for an established operator.²³

Advanced nuclear developers such as OKLO, SMR, and NNE need development-stage analysis: design and site approvals, fuel supply, construction funding, binding offtake, startup, and sustained commercial operation. The NRC's current Oklo page describes pre-application activity. Oklo's June-quarter filing separately describes the DOE pathway for Aurora-INL. Using NRC status alone to infer the status of every DOE-authorized project would be incorrect; a topical-report approval is also not equivalent to an operating plant.^{21,22}

Fuel and services businesses such as CCJ, LEU, UUUU, BWXT, and UEC need separate commodity, contract, production, enrichment, or service exposure analysis. A reactor developer, an existing nuclear generator, and a fuel supplier cannot share one revenue clock. Exact project operating dates are not verified across this group; do not use a blanket near-term revenue assumption.

The remainder of the tracker should remain visible under its own drivers. Aerospace and space names such as RKL, ASTS, LUNR, and AVAV need launch, production, funding, and customer milestones. Housing-linked HD and LOW need housing and renovation demand. Software names require evidence of adoption and monetization; bitcoin operations require mining economics where that exposure persists. These are proposed research dimensions, not fresh issuer forecasts.

AI efficiency is another two-sided variable. Less energy per task can reduce resource intensity while lower cost enables more usage. The IEA emphasizes both efficiency gains and more demanding applications. Model aggregate consumption, realized utilization, and workload mix rather than assuming either permanent scarcity or automatic demand destruction.²⁰

20. [International Energy Agency](#) 21. [US Nuclear Regulatory Commission](#) 22. [Oklo](#) 23. [Constellation Energy](#)

Calendar and investment horizons

An event date, an operating milestone, an accounting period, and a holding period must be separate fields. A business can have a three-year buildout and a one-day stock repricing when financing closes. Conversely, a strong earnings report may reveal that most cash generation lies beyond a near-term option expiration.

Timing	Evidence status	What to examine
September 10, 2026: Oracle Q1 FY27	Reported	Capacity conversion, infrastructure growth, cash flow and completed equity funding [5]
September 30, 2026: Micron FY26 Q4 call	Issuer-confirmed scheduled event	HBM and broader memory supply, pricing, commitments and manufacturing plans [24]
October 12-15, 2026: OCP Global Summit	Organizer-confirmed scheduled event	Power distribution, cooling, connectivity and architecture standards; distinguish demos from orders [25]
Q3/Q4 2026 product and delivery updates	Management guidance, company-specific	Astera product mix; IREN commissioning; supplier shipments [8,17]
Late 2026 capacity, mainly 2027 revenue contribution	Nebius management outlook	Delivery, billable activation, contract mix, funding and cash obligations [18]
Year-end 2026: GEV order/slot metric	Management target	Whether 125 GW combined target is reached and its composition [14]
2027: Crane restart	Constellation management expectation	Remaining milestones and actual startup; not presumed operating today [23]
2027-2030+ infrastructure pipeline	Conditional developer outlook	Grid approval, financing, construction, equipment and customer acceptance [19]

Micron is an external bellwether and is absent from the current tracker. It can inform existing semiconductor and equipment research without being added to the eligible universe. OCP is a technical information opportunity, not a predictable positive stock catalyst. Future issuer earnings dates should be confirmed when published rather than filled from a prior-year pattern.

Use three explicit research horizons. The event horizon spans the next catalyst and its price response. The operating horizon spans two to eight quarters of orders, ramps, commissioning, and financial conversion. The structural horizon spans several years of manufacturing, generation, grid, and architecture investment. These are proposed analytical windows, not changes to runtime gates or trade holding instructions.

For every thesis, specify the next evidence date and what would change the assessment. For an ALAB product-ramp hypothesis, it could be disclosed product contribution and gross profit at the next report. For an IREN commissioning hypothesis, it could be acceptance and operating revenue from the targeted phases. A fixed weekly schedule should not manufacture an update when no new evidence exists.

The instrument is selected only after the catalyst and economic horizon are clear. A call spread caps upside and expires; shares retain exposure beyond a single date; a longer option adds time but still requires a premium and volatility assessment. A long-term industry thesis alone supplies neither a short-term expected move nor a profitable option price.

5. [Oracle](#) 8. [Astera Labs](#) 14. [GE Vernova](#) 17. [IREN](#) 18. [Nebius Group](#) 19. [Cipher Digital](#) 23. [Constellation Energy](#) 24. [Micron](#) 25. [Open Compute Project](#)

Model measurements and proposed research design

The model needs a business layer, an expectations layer, and an instrument layer. Combining them into one score too early hides whether a company lacks evidence, has poor economics, is already expensive, or merely lacks an immediate catalyst. Discovery coverage should be reported before any selection or execution gate is considered.

Measurement	Definition and use	Important failure mode
Exposure materiality	Disclosed revenue, gross profit, or identifiable contract exposure by relevant end market	Sector labels or promotional language substitute for economics
Order quality	Firm orders, reservations, and cancellations separately; deposits and customer identity when public	Backlog and pipeline counted as equally certain
Conversion	Delivered or billable capacity versus prior committed schedule; backlog recognized by cohort	Current shipments divided by unrelated backlog
Unit economics	Comparable gross profit or cash contribution per product, MW, rack, or GPU cohort	Hardware mix, power units, or service scope changes
Funding and dilution	Committed funding versus remaining obligations; interest, leases, share count	Positive EBITDA treated as shareholder cash flow
Expectations	Timestamped consensus, guidance revisions, and valuation scenarios	Fast growth assumed to be unanticipated
Market response	Return versus relevant industry benchmark over a predeclared horizon	Beta or sector strength mislabeled as selection skill
Instrument economics	Scenario payoffs after premium, fees, spread and expiration	Stock upside confused with option profit

Each value needs a source URL or filing, publication time, financial period, units, definition, and observed-versus-guided status. Missing information remains missing. Where the data are not comparable, display the issue rather than force a rank. Neutral placeholders are not measured business facts.

The existing growth transformation clips revenue growth at 50%, and theme scores assign fixed category credit. Those are modeling hypotheses. Once periods and inputs are reconciled, compare robust continuous growth and segment-specific features against the frozen baseline. Higher growth can reflect a small denominator, acquisition, pricing, or a temporary shortage; removing a clip does not resolve those distinctions.¹

Preserve a neutral record for every current tracker name before selecting a compute-intensive research subset. Use issuer-backed economic labels with overlapping exposures and source confidence. A future implementation should be tested first outside production because labels currently influence score and lane behavior. It must distinguish a coverage repair from changes to trade eligibility.

The preferred first challenger is therefore issuer-backed exposure and milestone evidence at a declared horizon. It should be compared with the current model and a simple industry-relative momentum baseline. Arbitrarily loosening all filters would mix coverage improvements, more beta, poorer execution, and genuine predictive changes into one uninterpretable result.

1. Frozen local coverage audit.

Validation and immediate research work

This report establishes additional research evidence and identifiable measurement limitations. It does not establish a validated stock-picking edge or a higher probability of reaching a wealth target. The production model's safety, risk, eligibility, and paper-evidence rules remain in place. Discovery design can be improved while those independent questions remain unresolved.

The first work package is coverage and provenance. Reconcile FIX's growth period with its filing; require period and source fields; make missing edge metadata explicit; and design full-tracker economic coverage without relying on the top-40 selection. Acceptance means every tracker name has a sourced classification or a specific unresolved classification reason, and every proposed numerical feature has a defined period and units.

The second is a bounded comparison of the highest-value business mechanisms. Start with connectivity (ALAB, CRDO, ANET, LITE), physical delivery (VRT, ETN, GEV, FIX), and capacity conversion (ORCL, IREN, CRWV, NBIS). For each, assemble current guidance, the next milestone, materiality to revenue and gross profit, funding requirements, diluted-share scenarios, and a dated expectations record. These are research subjects, not orders or price-based preferences.

The third is a point-in-time evaluation. Freeze the target, horizon, benchmark, universe, feature definitions, costs, and success criterion before inspecting future outcomes. Preserve selected and rejected names. Group repeated versions of the same event and closely related exposures so one event does not masquerade as many independent wins. Do not backfill today's disclosures into historical predictions.

An illustrative experiment can evaluate whether the issuer-backed challenger improves 63-trading-day benchmark-relative return versus the baseline, with the same number of selections and capital assumptions. Define a missed winner in advance, for example a name that exceeds the benchmark by a fixed, predeclared amount over that horizon. Report recovered winners together with added losers, drawdowns, turnover, and uncertainty. The numerical definition must be fixed before evaluation; no threshold is adopted here.

For an options study, capture the actual contract and contemporaneous tradable quote before the catalyst. Evaluate direction, magnitude, timing, and net instrument payoff separately. Share-price history alone cannot establish that a particular spread was fillable or profitable. Different expirations and structures should be compared on the same opportunity and consistent risk basis.

Existing research grades, arithmetic checks, paper observations, and an independent live trade answer different questions. Source-verified model improvement requires new outcomes under the frozen protocol. A stronger industry thesis is valuable progress, but it is not a substitute for measured strategy performance.

Limitations and decisions

Issuer releases establish reported facts and management expectations; they are not independent forecasts. Current prices and consensus estimates are the largest missing inputs for ranking expected stock returns. No complete issuer-by-issuer valuation or contract audit of all 183 names is claimed. Provider taxonomy and cache fields are preserved as observations, with their limitations.

The research conclusion is to broaden business recognition and use the proper timeline before adjusting thresholds. Prioritize product adoption, executable construction, and funded capacity conversion. Judge success through common-share economics and out-of-sample outcomes, while keeping evidence quality visible at every stage.

Sources

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